

Dear Andrew,

You asked the best question in your notes: **how do you create a commercial business development manager instead of hiring one?** This letter is our answer.

Start here. **785 buildings in West Yorkshire are under a live fire safety enforcement notice** — care homes, schools, hotels, warehouses, high-rise flats. Every one names the premises and the responsible company. It sits in a public register, free. Barbour took £12,000 a year and never showed it to you.

We know the number because we've already pulled the register — all 1,441 West Yorkshire records, as at 13 August. That part isn't a proposal; it's done, and we can show you it running.

Before we get to what we'd build, three things you already own.

Three things you already have

Talk Your Job Sheet. BigChange's Lightning AI already does it, and you rate it. Struck off our list.

The recurring-service sweep. You asked whether this was already in your CRM and you weren't using it. It is — Service Reminders generates work orders on a schedule and sends customers a link to book the repeat visit. If it isn't switched on, doing that this month is worth more to you than anything we could build, and it costs nothing.

Your "Booking Site" is BigChange's own portal — not something you had built, and only skin-deep customisable. The navigation problem you described is a limit of their product, not a mistake at your end. Worth checking whether you pay for that module separately.

Where the opportunity is

Take out everything BigChange already does, and four things remain — all outside your CRM's remit, which is why they've been missed.

1. The standards watch — your idea, and the best one in the document

You wrote that new standards and bulletins get missed, that staying on top of them is required for your accreditations, and that service cycles often tighten when standards publish — which increases your revenue, unless it goes missed.

We went looking for something that already does this. **There isn't one.** BSI sell change-monitoring built for medical device manufacturers. Barbour sell it to health-and-safety managers, and it stops at telling you what changed — same group that took your £12,000, incidentally. Nothing tells a contractor *which of their own clients* a change affects and prompts them to advise them. That's the part that makes you money, and it's the part nobody sells.

It would watch the sources, spot a change, work out which of your clients have that system type, and put a prompt in front of the right person:

"BS 5839-1 revised — these eleven clients have that system — here's the advisory letter, send it?"

And here is where we'd rather be straight with you than sell you something. We've confirmed the gap in the market. We have *not* yet confirmed we can detect every change reliably — the most promising source, BSI's own standards update index, doesn't publish anything a machine can read cleanly, and the trade bodies vary. The other half depends on pulling your client list by system type out of BigChange, which is question two below.

So we won't quote this one yet. What we'd do in the first fortnight is find out, and tell you either way — including if the answer is that it can't be done properly. It's the biggest prize here and it's your idea, which is exactly why it deserves a straight answer rather than an invoice.

One limit that won't change: British Standards are BSI copyright, so it can tell you a standard changed and point to the official summary, but never reproduce the text. Nor can anyone else.

2. Your website

You liked the draft, and it's largely built. The quickest visible win available — and it fixes real problems. Your current site has no headline or description on a single page, nothing a search engine can read about the business, and analytics that stopped recording in **July 2023**. Which means nobody can currently prove where a single enquiry comes from.

3. Private-sector leads, running automatically

You said the offering leaned public-sector. Fair. The two strongest private-sector sources turned out to be the two we said least about.

Care homes. Mostly private, with their own budgets, as you say. The CQC rates every one on "Safe" — which explicitly covers fire safety, maintenance checks and equipment records — and publishes the list free, monthly. A home marked down on Safe has an inspector returning and a problem to fix.

Enforcement notices. You were right that some go nowhere, and you made the argument better than we did: if 30% come through, they're leads that would never have existed, and automated, there's no cost per lead. Of the 1,441 West Yorkshire records, **549 were served in the last twelve months** and **604 are on high-rise flats, warehouses, care homes, hotels, schools and hospitals** — your customer base.

Both of these we have already built the hard part of. The care home list is a file the regulator publishes fresh every month — the current one is dated 12 August. **This is what we'd build first, because it's the one we can show you working rather than describe.**

One practical note: where a notice names a company, normal business-to-business rules apply. Where it names an individual — and some do — marketing rules are stricter and the number needs screening first. We'd build that in from the start.

4. Live tender tracking

Finding tenders isn't your problem — you've solved that. Tracking live ones across portals that don't talk to each other, with daily updates and shifting requirements forcing rewrites of documents you'd finished, is. We couldn't find anyone who's built that for a firm your size.

What we'd park

Live alarm signals in the portal. CSL don't publish a route for a third party to reach that data — it goes to the monitoring station. If CSL or DSOC open one, we'll build it. Until then, parked.

Constructionline status would be typed by hand and go stale. **The AI video check of an installation** was the most original idea in your document and we'd love to attempt it — it's also unproven, so it belongs after we've earned the right, not in a first invoice.

How it would work

Week 1 — Measurement on. Analytics fixed, website live. Everything after this is measurable; nothing before it is.

Weeks 2–4 — The lead radar, working: enforcement notices and CQC-flagged care homes across your patch, filtered to your building types, landing somewhere you'll actually look. We start here because we've already proved the data.

In parallel — We answer the standards watch question, and quote it or rule it out.

Week 5 — You decide: carry on, or stop. No notice period, no minimum term.

Then one new tool every three to four weeks, in whatever order you think is worth most.

What it would cost

We want Faelsafe as the reference client for this side of our business, so the first step is priced to be an easy yes: see it working, then decide.

A Start with the proven part (<i>our recommendation</i>)	£2,500 — website live, analytics fixed, and the lead radar running on real data. Yours to keep either way. After a month you carry on or stop, nothing further owed.
B A fixed programme	£9,000 for the above plus two more tools across three months. Below what BarbourABI cost you, for things built around how you actually work.
C Share the upside	£500/month plus 5% of first-year work traced to what we built — counted as jobs won from leads our tools flagged, logged in BigChange. We carry the risk with you.

The standards watch is quoted separately, once we've confirmed it's deliverable. It's the most valuable thing on this list and we'd expect it to be the largest single piece of work — which is exactly why it shouldn't be bundled into a first invoice on a promise.

Running costs are a few pounds a month. You own everything outright — no licence, no per-user fee, no annual renewal creeping up.

For scale: a commercial business development manager is £45,000–£60,000 plus car and commission. Every option above sits a long way below that.

What good looks like

Every tool gets one agreed number, reviewed monthly. If it hasn't moved, we say so and stop.

WHAT WE BUILD	THE NUMBER	WHERE IT STARTS
Website + analytics	Enquiries a month, and their source	No data since July 2023 — baseline set in week one
Standards watch	Clients advised, service intervals raised	Effectively zero today
Care home radar	Homes flagged → quotes → jobs won	Your current care home win rate
Enforcement radar	Notices → approaches → jobs won	549 notices last year you never saw
Tender tracking	Bids submitted, hours on bid admin, win rate	Bids per quarter now

You'll see the whole picture each month — what converted and what didn't. A tool that flatters itself is worth less than no tool.

Next

Half an hour, with whoever runs BigChange alongside you. Three things to settle:

1. **Three questions only BigChange can answer** — are you paying separately for the Booking Site module; can certificates be pulled from their standard interface or does that need their paid data product; and does a defect flagged on a worksheet already become a quote? The middle one decides whether a customer certificate portal is affordable.
2. **Which tool first** — we'd say the standards watch, but it's your business.
3. **Which option** — A, B or C.

Whenever suits you, and we'll come to Morley if that's easier. Bring the register up on the screen while we're there and you can see your own patch in it.

Yours sincerely,

P.S. — Every figure above is written up with its source: the enforcement register, the care home lists, the standards bodies, and exactly what we could and couldn't confirm about BigChange. We'd rather you checked us.